

READ ME: How to use the script to access WID data (using R)

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This document provides a step-by-step guide for using the script `user-script.R`, which offers easy access to World Inequality Database (WID) data. Each section describes the corresponding code chunk in the script.

The script is located in the **World Inequality Database** folder, which should be downloaded from the official WID GitHub repository. A detailed description of the folder structure is available in Appendix 1.2.

What does the script do? It automates access to WID data, processes and cleans the selected series based on the countries and indicators specified by the user. The cleaned datasets are saved in the **Cleaned WID Data** folder.

Section 1: Download Method Selection

Data can be downloaded via two methods: the WID R command (`download_wid()`) or the WID website. Both are automated and produce identical outputs. Users can set `command <- TRUE` to use the R command, or `command <- FALSE` to use the website.

For small datasets, the R command is faster. For large datasets (many countries, variables, percentiles, or any combination of these), the website method is more efficient. The `macro_income` series, `DINA_income` series, and large groups (notably *core countries*, *full world* and *all percentiles*) are particularly heavy. Use the website method when downloading `all_series`.

Occasionally, the R command may be temporarily unavailable. In such cases, the website method remains a reliable alternative as long as an internet connection is available.

Section 2: Countries Groups and Data Series Selection

The WID database can be broke down with respect to countries and data series, as shown in Figure 1 and Figure 2 (see next page). In Section 2 of `user-script.R`, users can choose the country group and series they need to download.

1. Users can select **one** country group corresponding to a light-blue shaded group in Figure 1 (note: “all countries” and “world average” are included in said groups), by setting `TRUE` exactly one country group (only one line should be set to `TRUE`).
2. Users can download **one or more** data series at the same time, selecting from those highlighted in yellow in Figure 2, by setting `TRUE` one or more data series.

NOTE: If you assign `TRUE` to every line except the last one (`all_series`), you will get one dataset per series. If you assign `TRUE` only to the last line, or to all lines, you will get a single dataset containing all series.

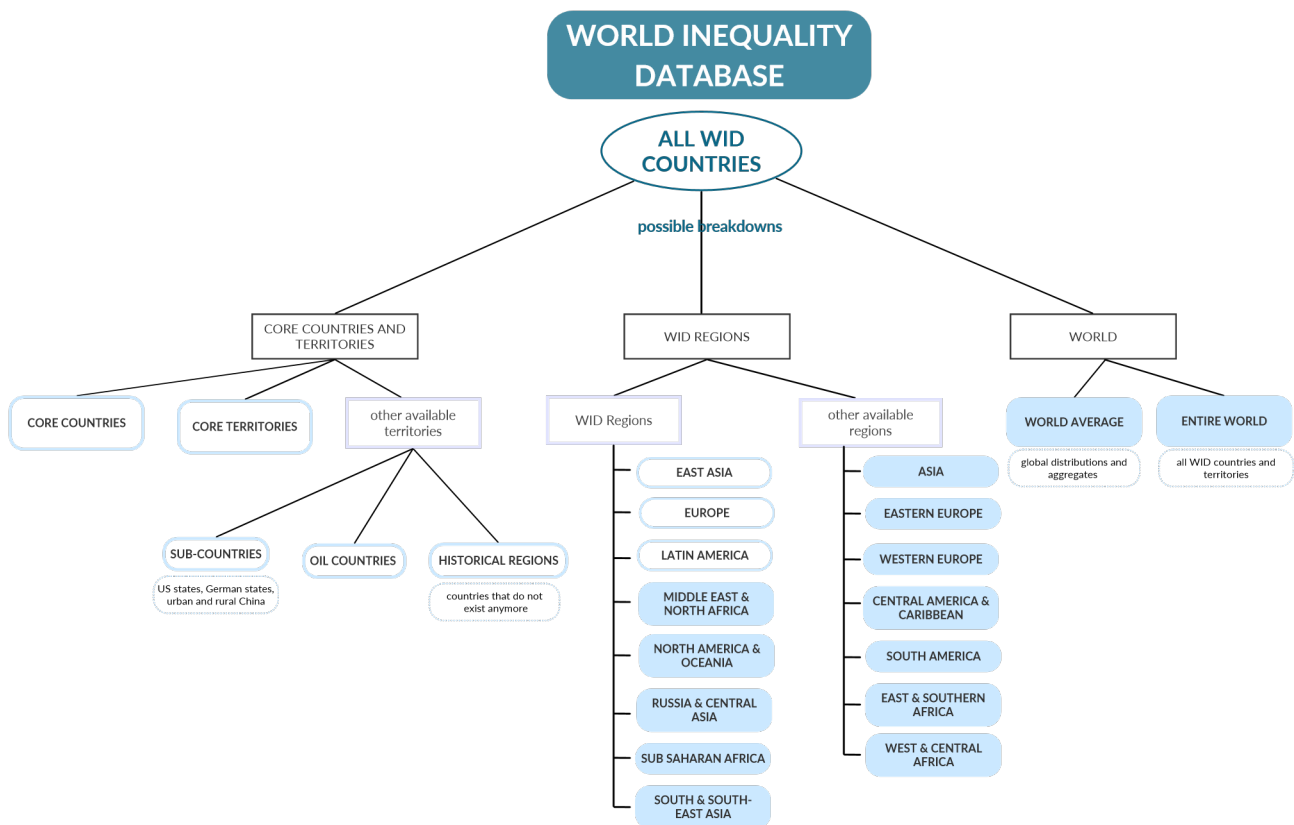


Figure 1: World Inequality Database, countries breakdown. Core countries and territories defined in the appendix 1.1. More info here: [WID country codes dictionary](#).

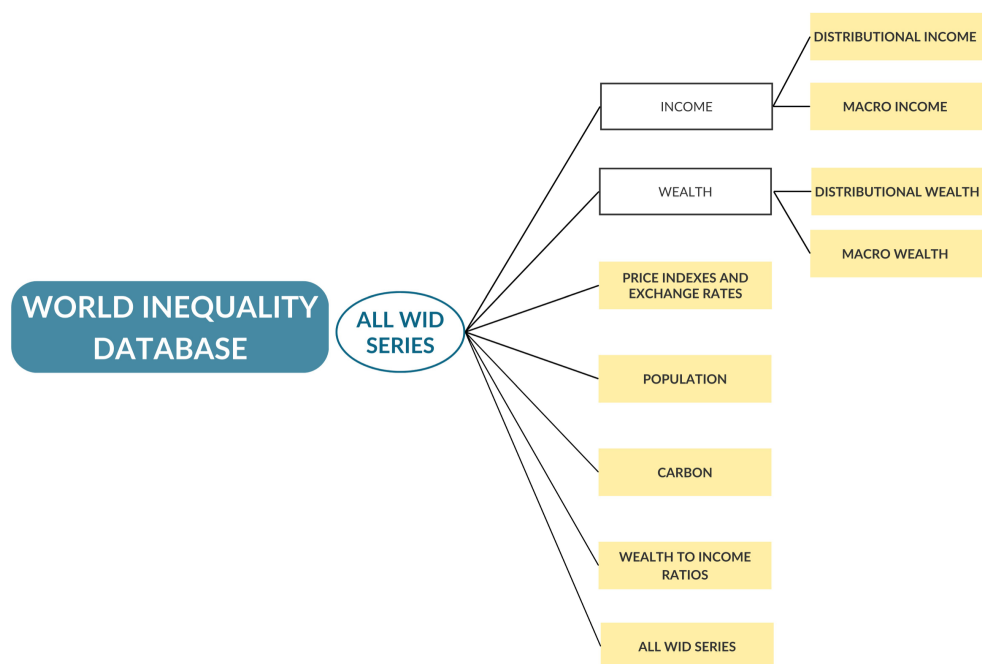


Figure 2: World Inequality Database, data series breakdown. More here: [WID codes dictionary](#).

Section 3: Percentiles Selection

Note: This section is only relevant if you are accessing distributional data. Otherwise, any values assigned to the variables here will be ignored by the code (including when accessing `all_data`).

The WID provides three types of distributional series: income, wealth, and carbon emissions. By default, the database offers a large set of distributional groups and percentiles (see here). When downloading distributional variables, the script allows you to select a specific grouping: **1.** deciles; **2.** groups (*p0p50*, *p50p90*, *p90p100*, *p99p100*); **3.** g-percentiles ¹.

NOTE: If you leave all group selections as `FALSE` (the default), the script will download all groups and percentiles, including *p0p100*, which represents the entire population, and all top and bottom percentiles (*pXp100* and *p0pX* respectively).

Section 4: Executing the Code

After carefully adjusting the parameter values throughout the script, the user is now ready to run the entire script. To do this, select all the code using **Ctrl + A**, then execute it with **Ctrl + Enter**.

Important: The script must be opened from within the **World Inequality Database** folder. Running it from any other location will cause execution errors.

Once the script starts running, the console will display messages indicating progress. First, it will list the countries (using their ISO codes) for which data are being downloaded. Then, two additional messages will mark the start and completion of data processing.

Upon successful execution, the cleaned data files will be saved in the **Cleaned WID Data** folder in .csv format, sub-folders are created when requested (see appendix 1.2). Datasets will include columns for price indexes and exchange rates, populated wherever monetary values are present. For detailed information on price and currency conversions, please refer to the Technical Note.

Example

For illustration, suppose the user wants to download *carbon series* data for *Western Europe*. Specifically, they are interested in distributional carbon data and choose to download *deciles* of the distribution. Because this is a relatively small dataset, they opt to use the *R WID command method*. On the next page, users will find an example of how the script should look like before executing it with **Ctrl + A** and **Ctrl + Enter**.

¹ *g-percentiles* divide the global population into 127 increasingly fine income brackets. From p0 to p99, the population is split into 1% intervals. Above p99, the granularity increases: from p99 to p99.9 in 0.1% steps, from p99.9 to p99.99 in 0.01% steps, and from p99.99 to p99.999 in 0.001% steps.

Notes for Users

A detailed flow chart illustrating the overall workflow, how the scripts interact, and what each script does is available separately (`code-flowchart.svg`). Users interested in the code's structure and functions are encouraged to consult the flow chart for a comprehensive overview.

We welcome feedback, suggestions, and improvements! Please **feel free to leave comments or open issues on the project's GitHub page**. Additionally, users are encouraged to adapt and modify the code to fit their own needs.

Example

```
# ----- [1] DOWNLOAD METHOD SELECTION -----

# Select download method (LOOK AT READ.ME)
# - set command <- TRUE to use WID
command # - set command <- FALSE to use
WID website

command <- TRUE

# ----- [2] SELECT DESIRED COUNTRIES -----

# Set ONE of the following lines to TRUE

# NOTE: set TRUE one (AND ONE ONLY) group of countries

# [1]: Core countries, territories, and other territories

main_corecountries <- FALSE # core countries - large data-set main_coreterritories <-
FALSE # core territories

main_subcountries <- FALSE # sub-countries main_historicalregions <- FALSE
# historical regions main_oilcountries <- FALSE # oil countries

# [2]: Regional Data

# [2.1] WID Regions:
coord_europe <- FALSE # Europe coord_ruca <- FALSE # Russia
and Central Asia coord_ea <- FALSE # East Asia
coord_ssa <- FALSE # South & South-East Asia coord_ssaf <- FALSE
# Sub Saharan Africa coord_mena <- FALSE # Middle East & North
Africa coord_latam <- FALSE # Latin America coord_naoc <- FALSE
# North America & Oceania

# [2.2] WID sub-regions:
coord_we <- TRUE # Western Europe coord_ee <- FALSE # Eastern
Europe coord_sa <- FALSE # South America coord_cac <- FALSE #
Central America & Caribbean coord_wca <- FALSE # West & Central
Africa coord_esa <- FALSE # East & Southern Africa

# [3]: World

full_world <- FALSE # Entire world - large data-set world_avg <- FALSE # World
aggregate values

# ----- [3] SELECT DESIRED WID SERIES -----

# Set ONE OR MORE of the following lines to TRUE

# Set all_data <- TRUE if you want a data-set with all series

DINA_income <- FALSE # distributional income series macro_income <- FALSE
# income macro series

DINA_wealth <- FALSE # distributional wealth series macro_wealth <- FALSE
# wealth macro series

price_indexes <- FALSE # MER, PPP exchange rates and price indexes carbon_series <- TRUE
# distributional and macro carbon series population_series <- FALSE # population
series from
ratios_and_shares <- FALSE # wealth/income ratios & labor/capital shares

all_data <- FALSE # all series - large data-set

# ----- [3.1] DINA DATA: PERCENTILES SELECTION -----

# - - - DISREGARD THIS SECTION IF YOU ARE NOT DOWNLOADING DISTRIBUTIONAL DATA - - - #

# Set ONE of the following lines to TRUE

g_percentiles <- FALSE # 127 generalized percentiles - large dataset deciles <-
TRUE # p010 - p10p20 - etc groups <- FALSE # p050, p50p90, p90p100, p99p100

# If all are set to FALSE, it defaults to downloading ALL percentiles and groups (including p0p100)

# ----- [4] EXECUTE CODE -----

source("Working_Folder/Setup_Scripts/get-data.R") # NOTE: check messages in the console
```

1 Appendix

1.1 Core countries and core territories lists

Region	Country name	Country ISO code
East Asia	China, Hong Kong, Japan, Korea, Macao, Mongolia, North Korea, Taiwan	CN, HK, JP, KR, MO, MN, KP, TW
Europe	Albania, Andorra, Austria, Belgium, Bosnia and Herzegovina, Bulgaria, Croatia, Cyprus, Czech Republic, Denmark, Estonia, Finland, France, Germany, Gibraltar, Greece, Guernsey, Hungary, Iceland, Ireland, Isle of Man, Italy, Jersey, Kosovo, Latvia, Liechtenstein, Lithuania, Luxembourg, Malta, Moldova, Monaco, Montenegro, Netherlands, North Macedonia, Norway, Poland, Portugal, Romania, San Marino, Serbia, Slovakia, Slovenia, Spain, Sweden, Switzerland, United Kingdom	AL, AD, AT, BE, BA, BG, HR, CY, CZ, DK, EE, FI, FR, DE, GI, GR, GG, HU, IS, IE, IM, IT, JE, KS, LV, LI, LT, LU, MT, MD, MC, ME, NL, MK, NO, PL, PT, RO, SM, RS, SK, SI, ES, SE, CH, GB
Latin America	Anguilla, Antigua and Barbuda, Argentina, Aruba, Bahamas, Barbados, Belize, Bolivia, Bonaire, Sint Eustatius and Saba, Brazil, Cayman Islands, Chile, Colombia, Costa Rica, Cuba, Curacao, Dominica, Dominican Republic, Ecuador, El Salvador, Grenada, Guatemala, Guyana, Haiti, Honduras, Jamaica, Mexico, Montserrat, Nicaragua, Panama, Paraguay, Peru, Puerto Rico, Saint Kitts and Nevis, Saint Lucia, Saint Vincent and the Grenadines, Sint Maarten (Dutch part), Suriname, Trinidad and Tobago, Turks and Caicos Islands, Uruguay, Venezuela, Virgin Islands	AI, AG, AR, AW, BS, BB, BZ, BO, BQ, BR, KY, CL, CO, CR, CU, CW, DM, DO, EC, SV, GD, GT, GY, HT, HN, JM, MX, MS, NI, PA, PY, PE, PR, KN, LC, VC, SX, SR, TT, TC, UY, VE, VG
MENA	Algeria, Bahrain, Egypt, Iran, Iraq, Israel, Jordan, Kuwait, Lebanon, Libya, Morocco, Oman, Palestine, Qatar, Saudi Arabia, Syrian Arab Republic, Tunisia, Turkey, United Arab Emirates, Yemen	DZ, BH, EG, IR, IQ, IL, JO, KW, LB, LY, MA, OM, PS, QA, SA, SY, TN, TR, AE, YE
North America & Oceania	Australia, Bermuda, Canada, Fiji, French Polynesia, Greenland, Kiribati, Marshall Islands, Micronesia, Nauru, New Caledonia, New Zealand, Palau, Samoa, Solomon Islands, Tonga, Tuvalu, USA, Vanuatu	AU, BM, CA, FJ, PF, GL, KI, MH, FM, NR, NC, NZ, PW, WS, SB, TO, TV, US, VU
Russia & Central Asia	Armenia, Azerbaijan, Belarus, Georgia, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Russian Federation, Tajikistan, Turkmenistan, Ukraine, Uzbekistan	AM, AZ, BY, GE, KZ, KG, RU, TJ, TM, UA, UZ
South & South-East Asia	Afghanistan, Bangladesh, Bhutan, Brunei Darussalam, Cambodia, India, Indonesia, Lao PDR, Malaysia, Maldives, Myanmar, Nepal, Pakistan, Papua New Guinea, Philippines, Singapore, Sri Lanka, Thailand, Timor-Leste, Viet Nam	AF, BD, BT, BN, KH, IN, ID, LA, MY, MV, MM, NP, PK, PG, PH, SG, LK, TH, TL, VN
Sub-Saharan Africa	Angola, Benin, Botswana, Burkina Faso, Burundi, Cabo Verde, Cameroon, Central African Republic, Chad, Comoros, Congo, Cote d'Ivoire, DR Congo, Djibouti, Equatorial Guinea, Eritrea, Ethiopia, Gabon, Gambia, Ghana, Guinea, Guinea-Bissau, Kenya, Lesotho, Liberia, Madagascar, Malawi, Mali, Mauritania, Mauritius, Mozambique, Namibia, Niger, Nigeria, Rwanda, Sao Tome and Principe, Senegal, Seychelles, Sierra Leone, Somalia, South Africa, South Sudan, Sudan, Swaziland, Tanzania, Togo, Uganda, Zambia, Zimbabwe	AO, BJ, BW, BF, BI, CV, CM, CF, TD, KM, CG, CI, CD, DJ, GQ, ER, ET, GA, GM, GH, GN, GW, KE, LS, LR, MG, MW, ML, MR, MU, MZ, NA, NE, NG, RW, ST, SN, SC, SL, SO, ZA, SS, SD, SZ, TZ, TG, UG, ZM, ZW

Figure 3: List of the 216 WID core countries, for each WID region.

Region	Country name	Country ISO code
East Asia	China, Japan, South Korea, Taiwan, Other East Asia	CN, JP, KR, TW, OB
Europe	United Kingdom, Denmark, France, Germany, Italy, Netherlands, Norway, Spain, Sweden, Other Western European Countries, Other Eastern European Countries	GB, DK, FR, DE, IT, NL, NO, ES, SE, OC, QM
Latin America	Argentina, Brazil, Chile, Colombia, Mexico, Other Latin America	AR, BR, CL, CO, MX, OD
MENA	Algeria, Egypt, Iran, Morocco, Saudi Arabia, Turkey, UAE, Other MENA	DZ, EG, IR, MA, SA, TR, AE, OE
North America & Oceania	USA, Canada, Australia, New Zealand, other North America & Oceania	US, CA, AU, NZ, OH
Russia & Central Asia	Russia, Other Russia & Central Asia	RU, OA
South & South-East Asia	Bangladesh, India, Indonesia, Myanmar, Pakistan, Philippines, Thailand, Vietnam, Other South & South-East Asia	BD, IN, ID, MM, PK, PH, TH, VN, OI
Sub-Saharan Africa	DR Congo, Ethiopia, Kenya, Ivory Coast, Mali, Niger, Nigeria, Rwanda, Sudan, South Africa, Other SSAF	CD, ET, KE, CI, ML, NE, NG, RW, SD, ZA, OJ

Figure 4: List of the 57 WID core territories, 48 countries and 9 residual regions.

1.2 Folder Structure

```
WORLD INEQUALITY DATABASE
|   READ-ME-R.pdf
|   READ-ME-STATA.pdf
|   user-script.R
|   user-do.do
|   code-flowchart.svg
|
\---Cleaned WID Data
|   +---Core Countries
|   +---Core Territories
|   +---Historical Regions
|   +---Oil Countries
|   +---Central America & Caribbean
|   +---East & Southern Africa
|   +---East Asia
|   +---Eastern Europe
|   +---Europe
|   +---Latin America
|   +---Middle East & North Africa
|   +---North America & Oceania
|   +---North America and Oceania
|   +---Russia & Central Asia
|   +---South & South-East Asia
|   +---Sub-Saharan Africa
|   +---West & Central Africa
|   +---Western Europe
|   +---Sub-Country Regions
|   +---Entire World
|   +---World Average
\---Working Folder
|   +---Raw Data
|   \---Setup Dos
|       country_code_vectors.do
|       get-data.do get-data-
|       command.do get-data-
|       website.do percentiles.do
|       requested-countries.do
|       series-all.do
|   \---Setup Scripts
|       country_code_vectors.R get-
|       data.R get-data-command.R
|       get-data-website.R
|       percentiles.R requested-
|       countries.R series-all.R
```

NOTE: This folder structure reflects the state after all regional folders have been created. The code creates each folder only when it is required.